ACTIVITY 2

NLP-Based Intelligent Writing Assistant

Autocorrect, Autocomplete, and POS-Aware Suggestions

teh → **the**

jumpd → **jumped**

ovr → **over**

Spell correction · next-word prediction · POS tagging — built from scratch in Python

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Introduction & Problem Statement

Background

A writing assistant built from scratch in Python — spell correction, next-word prediction and POS-aware suggestions.

Problem

Spell checkers ignore real error patterns; autocomplete ignores grammar.

Why it matters

Emails, messages and academic writing all suffer from context-blind corrections and ungrammatical suggestions.

Objectives — five modules

1. **Tokenizer**
   Regex-based word splitting
2. **Spell corrector**
   Noisy Channel, learned confusion matrix, edit distance ≤ 2
3. **N-Gram LM**
   Bigram + trigram with back-off
4. **POS tagger**
   HMM decoded with Viterbi
5. **Live Flask UI**
   Debounced AJAX, updates as you type

Literature Survey



CACM

Damerau

~80% of real typos are a single edit

IEEE Trans. Info. Theory

Viterbi

The decoding algorithm our POS tagger uses

ANLP

Church

HMM-style POS tagger on the Brown Corpus, 95–99% accuracy

COLING

Kernighan, Church & Gale

Noisy Channel spelling correction with learned confusion matrices — basis of our corrector

CSL

Chen & Goodman

Smoothing survey; explains our perplexity results

Research gap: these techniques are usually studied in isolation — we let the HMM filter the N-gram LM's suggestions in real time.

Proposed Methodology



Spell corrector

Candidates within edit distance 2, ranked by P(word) × P(typo | word). P(typo | word) learned from 12,356 real single-edit misspellings.

N-Gram language model

Trigram with back-off to bigram, Laplace smoothing; trained on Brown Corpus sentences.

HMM POS tagger

Bigram HMM over 10 Universal POS tags, decoded with the Viterbi algorithm.

POS-aware filter

Keep only next-word candidates whose tag matches the tag the HMM expects next.

Dataset & Experimental Setup

54,286
cleaned sentences
Brown Corpus (NLTK)

24,891
vocabulary words
frequency ≥ 2

54,270
POS-tagged sentences
10 Universal tags

38,218
real misspelling pairs
Norvig corpus, 7,841 words

Downloaded from: **Brown Corpus** — NLTK data (nltk.download('brown'), nltk.org/nltk_data) **Misspellings** — norvig.com/ngrams/spell-errors.txt

Preprocessing (Activity 1)

1. Lowercase
2. Strip punctuation
3. Tokenize
4. Length filter

Experimental setup



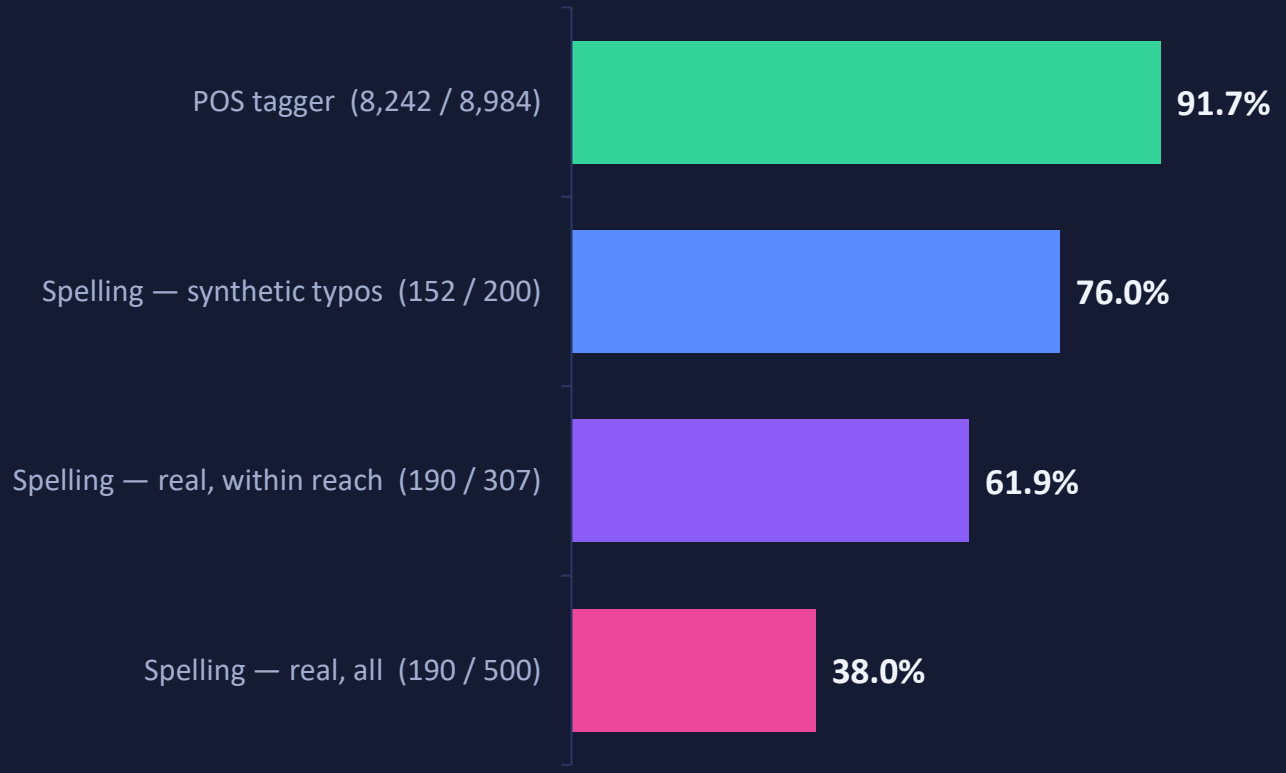
seed 42

Applied to all three datasets — every score is on unseen data.

Tools: Python 3.12 · Flask 3.1.3 · matplotlib

Results & Evaluation

Accuracy on held-out test data



5,596

Bigram perplexity

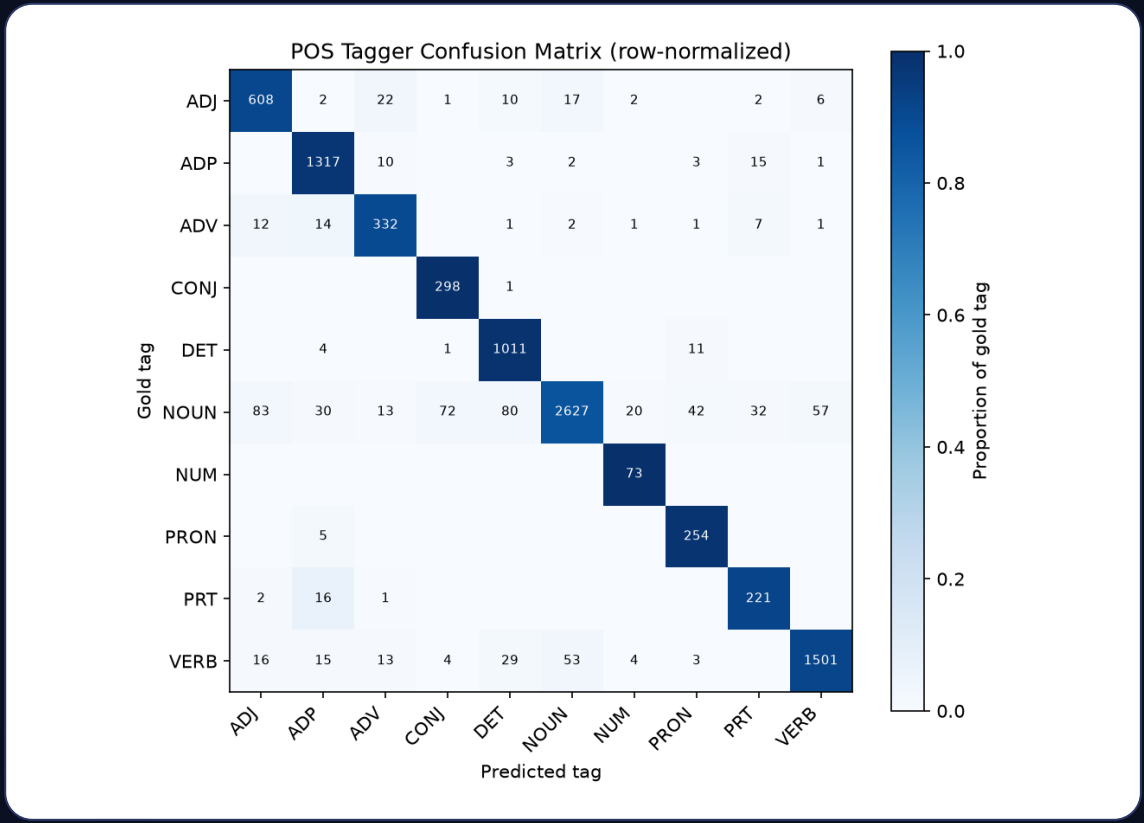
13,641

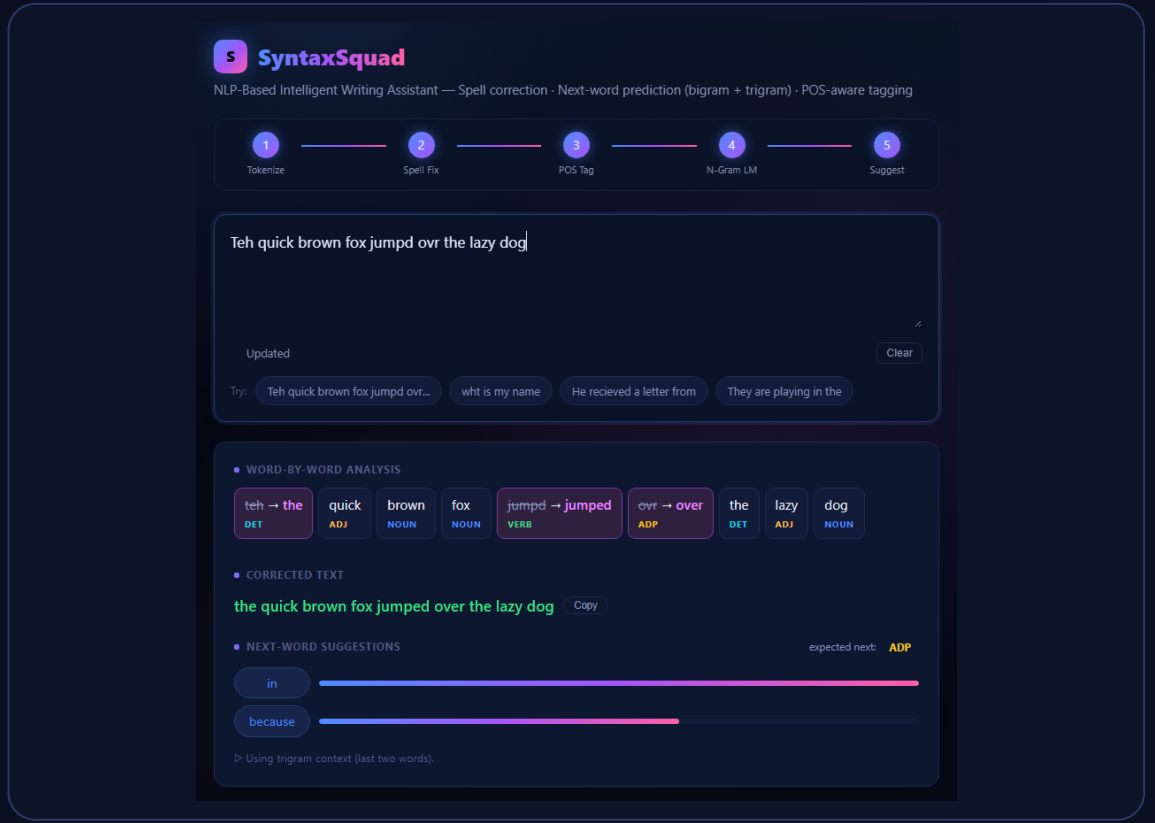
Trigram perplexity (with back-off)

Why is trigram higher? Laplace adds V ≈ 40K to every denominator, which swamps the sparse trigram counts.

193 of 500 real misspellings are 3+ edits away — out of reach by design.

Confusion Matrix & Live Output



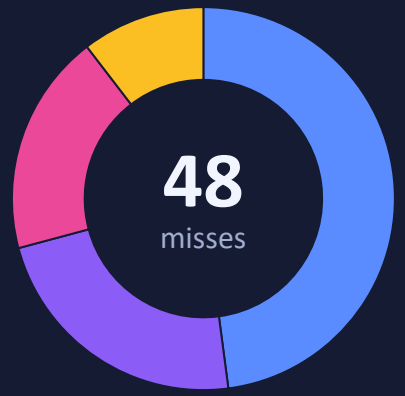


L **POS tagger confusion matrix**
Held-out set, strongly diagonal. Biggest confusions: NOUN → ADJ (83), DET (80), CONJ (72).

R **Live web app**
3 typos fixed, every word tagged, next-word suggestions filtered to the expected tag.

Error Analysis

Why the 48 synthetic-typo misses happened



- **23** ED-2 word beat ED-1
- **11** Other ED-1 word won
- **9** Real-word typo
- **5** Not in vocabulary

haed → “and”, not “head”: a very common word 2 edits away outranks the right word 1 edit away.

will → gill: a real word, so words corrected in isolation never flag it.

Fixed during testing

“ovr” used to give “or” and “wht” gave “who” — both now give “over” and “what”, thanks to the learned confusion matrix. Single-letter “I” → “in” also fixed.

POS confusions

NOUN mix-ups on ambiguous words like “that” — a bigram HMM only sees one previous tag.

Next fixes

Prefer 1-edit candidates · rank spelling in context · Kneser-Ney smoothing · trigram HMM.

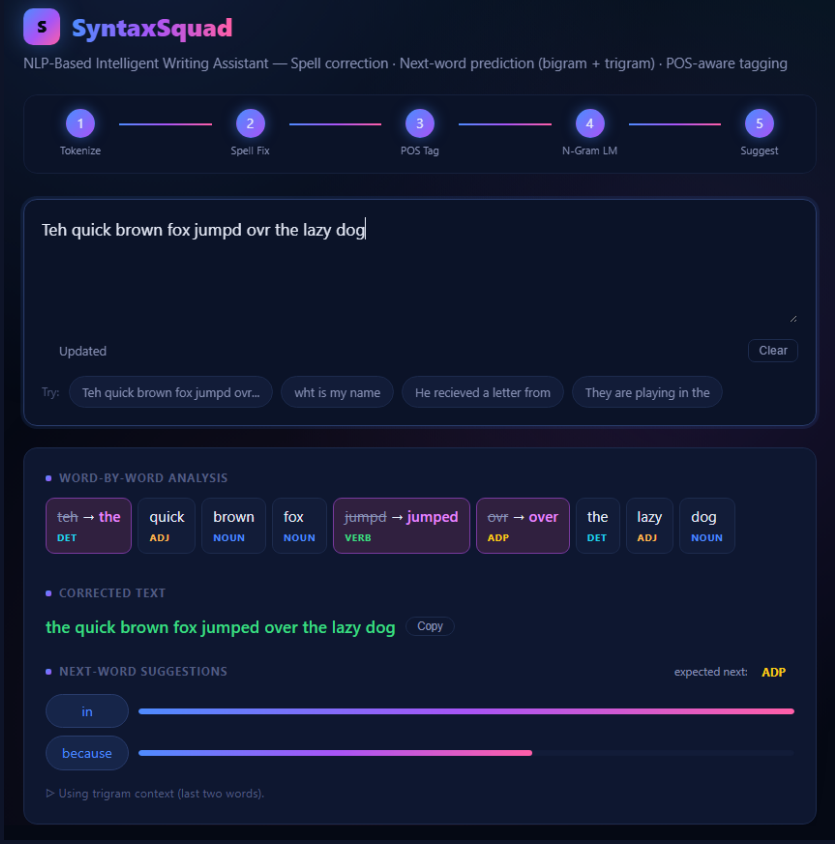
Project Proof

Source code on GitHub

github.com/AnoonMR/Writing-Assistant

```
$ pip install -r requirements.txt
$ cd src
$ python app.py
→ open http://127.0.0.1:5000
$ python evaluate.py   # reproduce every metric
```

Not publicly hosted — runs on localhost, fully offline once the data is downloaded.



Conclusion & Future Work

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modules built

At full proposal scope, integrated in one live web app and evaluated on held-out data.

91.74%

POS tagging accuracy

Spelling: 76.00% on synthetic typos and 61.9% on real misspellings within reach — all from scratch.

3

weak spots, all diagnosed

Each has a measured cause: frequency bias at edit distance 2, out-of-range misspellings, Laplace smoothing.

Future work

- Prefer 1-edit candidates
- Context-aware spelling
- Kneser-Ney smoothing
- Trigram HMM
- Optional hosting

AI Usage Acknowledgement



This project was developed with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic), an AI tool, which was used for code implementation and debugging.

References

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